

# Website setup guide

For the administrator - one-time setup

**About 1 to 2 hours. You need: the Memoria Judaica Gmail account, a computer with a browser and the unzipped package. Menu names on GitHub and Google can change slightly over time; the steps stay the same in spirit.**

**How it works:** the editors change the Google Sheet (a workbook with 8 tabs, containing every text of the site). "Publish website now" tells GitHub to rebuild the site. GitHub reads the whole workbook through a web link, builds the pages and publishes them. The contact form of the website sends its messages through the same script to the Gmail inbox. All of it is free except the domain name.

**Decide first: public or private code. The simplest free route uses a PUBLIC GitHub repository: anyone can read the website code (never passwords, those are kept elsewhere). If the code must stay private, GitHub Pages needs a paid plan; the free alternative is Cloudflare Pages, described in DOMAIN-AND-EMAIL-GUIDE.pdf (last section) with the ready file docs/deploy-cloudflare.yml.txt.**

## Step 1 - GitHub account (hosting and build)

1. Go to github.com, choose Sign up and use the Memoria Judaica Gmail address. Verify the e-mail.
2. Settings > Password and authentication: switch on two-factor authentication. Download the recovery codes, print them and keep them safe.
3. Later add a second trusted person as owner so the project does not depend on one login.

## Step 2 - Upload the website files

1. Unzip the package. Click + (top right) > New repository. Name: memoria-judaica. Choose Public (this keeps the build free). Create repository.
2. Click "uploading an existing file". Drag in everything from INSIDE the unzipped folder (not the folder itself). Commit changes to main.
3. Hidden folders such as .github are often skipped by the browser. Check that .github/workflows/deploy.yml exists. If not: Add file > Create new file, type the name .github/workflows/deploy.yml (typing a slash creates folders), paste the content of docs/deploy.yml.txt and commit.
4. The folder public/images holds about 25 files (photos, portraits, logo). If the browser upload stops, upload that folder separately.

## Step 3 - Switch on the website

1. Repository > Settings > Pages. Under "Build and deployment" set Source to GitHub Actions.
2. Open the Actions tab > "Publish website" > Run workflow. After 2-3 minutes there is a green tick.
3. Settings > Pages shows the address, normally <https://YOUR-USERNAME.github.io/memoria-judaica/> . Open it: the site is live with the built-in content.

## Step 4 - The Google Sheet (the content workbook)

1. Sign in to Google with the Memoria account. Open [drive.google.com](https://drive.google.com), click New > File upload and choose Memoria-Judaica-Content.xlsx (in the package).
2. Double-click the file, choose Open with > Google Sheets, then File > Save as Google Sheets. Rename it "Memoria Judaica - Content". From now on use only this Google Sheets copy; delete the uploaded .xlsx from Drive.
3. Check the tabs: Texts, Termine, Projects, Project texts, Team, Team texts, Legal pages, How to use. They already contain all current texts of the site in German, English and Hebrew.

## Step 5 - The script (menu, contact form and link)

1. In the sheet: Extensions > Apps Script. Delete the default code and paste the whole file [apps-script/Code.gs](https://github.com/memoria-judaica/apps-script/Code.gs). Replace YOUR-GITHUB-USERNAME with your GitHub user name. Check CONTACT\_TO: it is the Gmail address that receives the contact-form messages ([memoriajudaica@gmail.com](mailto:memoriajudaica@gmail.com); change it if the real address differs. Gmail addresses cannot contain a hyphen). Save.
2. Reload the sheet tab. The menu Website appears. Run Website > Set German date format (first time only) and allow access (Advanced > Go to project (unsafe) > Allow).
3. Run Website > Send a test contact e-mail. Google asks for one more permission (sending e-mail). Allow it. A test message arrives in the Gmail inbox (look in spam too). If it does not, the contact form cannot work either.

## Step 6 - Publishing key and web link

1. GitHub > profile picture > Settings > Developer settings > Personal access tokens > Fine-grained tokens > Generate new token. Name: memoria-sheet. Expiration: 1 year (put a reminder in the calendar). Repository access: Only select repositories > memoria-judaica. Repository permissions > Actions: Read and write. Generate and copy the token (shown only once).
2. In Apps Script: Project Settings (gear) > Script properties > Add script property: name GITHUB\_TOKEN, value = the token. Treat it like a password.
3. In Apps Script click Deploy > New deployment > type Web app. Execute as: Me. Who has access: Anyone. Deploy, allow access and copy the Web app link.
4. The link returns the whole content of the workbook as data (website content, public anyway) and accepts the contact-form messages. It is long and unguessable; never put private information into the workbook.
5. On GitHub open [site.config.json](#) > pencil icon > paste the link between the quotes after "contentUrl" > Commit changes. A build starts automatically. The contact form uses this same link.

## Step 7 - Test

1. In the sheet change the English text of "hero" in the tab Texts to TEST, then Website > Check my entries > Publish website now.
2. After about 3 minutes open the website, switch to EN and look at the home page. Then restore the text and publish again.

3. Open the page Kontakt, fill in the form with your own e-mail address and send it. The message should arrive in the Gmail inbox within a minute, with your address as reply address. Robots are filtered out (hidden field, minimum time of 3 seconds, at most 20 messages per hour).
4. A red cross in the GitHub Actions tab means the build stopped: open it and read the error (it names the tab and row). The live site is never changed by a failed build.
5. If you later change Code.gs: Deploy > Manage deployments > pencil > Version: New version > Deploy (the link stays the same).

## Step 8 - Hand over to the editors

- Share the sheet with the couple (Share > add their Google accounts as Editor, or let them use the Memoria account).
- Print docs/EDITOR-GUIDE.pdf in large print, write your contact on the last line and practise once together.

## Pictures

Pictures are not in the sheet. Logo and photos live in the folder public/images of the repository: to replace one, upload a new file with the SAME name (Add file > Upload files into public/images).

- **Team photos:** upload the file and write its name in the tab Team, column C.
- **Project photos:** upload the files (JPG, about 1800 px wide, under 600 KB each) and write the file names in the tab Projects, column Photo file name. Several names separated by commas plus Photo gallery = Yes make the picture carousel (Bad Kissingen uses bad-kissingen-01.jpg to bad-kissingen-10.jpg).
- **Other fixed pictures:** logo.png, photo.jpg (home page strip), cookbook-background.jpg (faint handwriting behind the cookbook text).

## Own domain, e-mail addresses and private code

Everything about memoria-judaica.de, the forwarding of info@, mueller@, huettenmeister@ and bondy@ to Gmail, the optional .com and .org addresses and the private-code option is in DOMAIN-AND-EMAIL-GUIDE.pdf.

## Before the site goes public

- **Addresses:** confirm the e-mail and website address in the tab Texts (keys emailAddress and websiteAddress). info@memoria-judaica.de and www.memoria-judaica.de are assumptions.
- **Datenschutz:** the page in the tab Legal pages is still a placeholder. It must be completed (naming the hosting provider, Cloudflare for DNS and mail forwarding, Google for the contact form script and the Gmail inbox) and ideally reviewed by a professional.
- **Impressum:** it names Nathanja Hüttenmeister as responsible for the content and Ankur Saxena for the technical implementation. The couple should confirm both. The footer shows the technical credit only on the Kontakt page.
- **Texts still missing:** the Hessian small projects (the page shows "Coming Soon...").
- **Languages:** German is complete. English is complete except that titles of publications stay in their original language. Hebrew is a draft for page texts, projects, events, career entries and headings; publication lists and legal paragraphs stay German. The couple proofread with Hebrew-Proofreading-List-Round2.xlsx.

- **Photos:** check the rights for every photo. Credits exist for Bad Kissingen (Rolf Nachbar) and Ingenheim (Michael Brocke); the Hammelburg, Laudenbach and home photos still need credits if required.

## Safety and upkeep

- Keep two-factor login on and the recovery codes safe. Keep a second administrator.
- Renew the GitHub token before it expires (yearly) and replace it in Script properties.
- Undo a bad publish: GitHub > Actions > open an earlier green run > Re-run all jobs. GitHub also keeps the history of every file.
- Make a copy of the Google Sheet every few months (File > Make a copy) as a backup.
- There is deliberately no automatic nightly timer: GitHub switches scheduled jobs off after 60 days without activity in public repositories. The Publish button always works.
- GitHub may ask you to update the versions listed in `.github/workflows/deploy.yml` over the years; it sends an e-mail first. Keep this ZIP as a backup.